

Deliberation and Learning: Evidence From Deliberative Polls

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Abstract

Among the great virtues ascribed to deliberation is learning. We ask how much participants in Deliberative Polls learn, what control groups tell us about those gains, and who learns. Respondent-level answers to 245 knowledge questions cover 31 polls held from 1994 to 2024 on elections, energy, health, crime, climate, and other policy issues across Europe, Australia, the Americas, Africa, and Asia. In the 28 polls with verified discussion-group identifiers, 8,800 attendees in 592 groups supply paired item answers. Across these polls, the share of items answered correctly rose by .136 [.108, .163], or .180 [.145, .215] after adjustment for guessing. A broader 31-poll analysis appears in the appendix. Four polls also have control-group answers, although Northern Ireland’s controls were interviewed only at T3. In the three control polls with common baseline interviews, held in seven countries, attendees scored .49 standard deviations above controls after adjustment for initial knowledge (95% interval .36 to .62); in one poll followed for a year, 45% of that adjusted gap remained. Some control comparisons show larger adjusted gaps among those starting with less knowledge or without degrees. Groupmates’ prior knowledge has no detectable adjusted association with participants’ T2 scores, though group composition is not fully balanced on T1 knowledge.

1 Introduction

Among the great virtues commonly ascribed to deliberation is learning. The participants learn about the topics under discussion and, to a lesser degree, incidentally, about related ones. They learn not only relevant facts but the arguments for and against particular alternatives and what other people unlike themselves, their circumstances, and their ways of thinking are like. This is helpful, both at the individual level, for discerning what policies most closely accord with one’s values and interests and voting accordingly, and at the aggregate level, for forming “authentic” majorities—majorities that “know what they are doing” (Luskin 2003). How much citizens know shapes what they prefer and how they vote (Converse 1964; Bartels 1996; Althaus 1998; Delli Carpini and Keeter 1996), even on foreign policy (Aldrich et al. 1989; Foyle 2004), though information shortcuts can partly stand in for knowledge (Popkin 1991; Lupia 1994).

The expectation of learning follows directly from the nature of “deliberation,” conventionally construed as discussion, but not just any discussion (Fishkin and Luskin 2005). While definitions vary, deliberation is generally viewed as normatively elevated discussion—in which, among other things, the participants clarify and refine their preferences by open-mindedly weighing competing arguments. As part of that weighing, they absorb factual information and sift out misinformation.

Or so the theory runs. But how much do participants actually learn, is it the deliberation that teaches them, and who learns the most? We examine learning of relevant facts. This is not the

only sort of learning involved, but it is the easiest to measure, and it is both important in itself and positively correlated with the rest.

Participants gain knowledge during Deliberative Polls. In three polls that surveyed a control group at baseline and follow-up—two in the United States and one across six middle-income countries—attendees scored .49 standard deviations above controls after adjustment for initial knowledge. In the one poll re-interviewed a year later, 45% of that adjusted gap remained. Northern Ireland also interviewed a T3 control group, without baseline knowledge questions. Earlier studies of Deliberative Polls and other forums found that participants learn a lot (Luskin et al. 2002; Barabas 2004; Sturgis et al. 2005; Esterling et al. 2011; Theuwis et al. 2025), but most compared participants before and after, without a comparison group. We also examine how gains vary with starting knowledge and schooling. We also examine whether groupmates’ initial knowledge is associated with learning and check how balanced group composition is at baseline.

2 Deliberative Polling and Learning

Deliberative Polling (Fishkin 1991, 1995; Luskin et al. 2002) aims to capture fuller-information, more thoughtful opinions than those expressed in ordinary polls. In very brief, a Deliberative Poll interviews and assembles, as many as are willing of, a random sample to deliberate some policy or electoral choice, in alternating small group discussions and plenary question-and-answer sessions with panels of competing experts, and then re-measures the sample’s opinions at the end. These latter are frequently different, both at the individual level and in the aggregate, from what they were before deliberating. The absolute net change is statistically significant nearly three-quarters of the time and averages nearly .1 on a 0–1 scale (Luskin et al. 2007).

This design, admittedly a particular embodiment of deliberation, affords additional opportunities and incentives to learn. The participants are provided with carefully balanced briefing documents, rehearsing the arguments each side would make. There is usually a section of basic background information, and the arguments embed each side’s pet facts—those most congenial to its arguments. In addition, the participants know from the moment they are first recruited that they will be attending the deliberation and that the deliberation (typically) will be an “Event,” capital “e”—away from home, usually televised or taped for later broadcast, often attended by high-profile policy experts or policy-makers in the role of observers or panelists. Thus, motivated by a desire to “do well,” many participants use the weeks between their recruitment and the event itself to prepare—not only by reading the briefing materials but by paying heightened attention to stories about the topic in the media, by talking more with friends, family, and coworkers about it, and even, in some cases, by researching it in the library or online.

So if knowledge, like its close relative “sophistication,” depends on the confluence of cognitive ability, motivation, and exposure to relevant information (Luskin 1990, 2002), the deliberation in Deliberative Polling stands to increase two of those three. There is not much to be done, in adulthood, about ability—and in fact we should want the participants to be representative in this, as in all other respects. But the treatment can and does affect motivation and exposure. Judging from past polls, that is enough to produce considerable, sometimes dramatic learning (Luskin et al. 2002; List et al. 2013).

The online design is intended to be as similar as possible to the face-to-face one, given the difference in mode. The deliberation is by voice rather than text, so as to capture as much as possible of deliberation’s social elements. The participants still “meet” in small groups, still led by trained

moderators, and still question panels of policy experts and policy makers. They still receive briefing materials. They are still a representative sample—sometimes randomly sampled offline, with “nonusers” receiving free access, including free equipment, to get them online, sometimes drawn from online panels and matched to approximate a random sample. On the other hand, deliberating by voice, even by video, online can never capture the full richness and complexity of in-person interactions; the discussions are interrupted, spread over a period of weeks, with much greater possibility of real-world intrusion, and the assignment to small groups is perforce constrained by possible meeting times. All these differences may act to weaken the online treatment’s effects (Luskin et al. 2006; Iyengar et al. 2005).

3 Data

We include polls with respondent-level knowledge-item answers at both T1 and T2. Each poll appears once in the upstream registry and in Appendix A. The accompanying dp-data repository holds the item definitions, scored responses, respondent links, group assignments, and poll metadata. We join its participant and score tables into one paired-attendee panel, selecting one source for each poll where releases overlap. We average correctness over the questions fielded to a respondent to obtain the proportion correct before (T1) and after (T2) deliberating. The main attendee analyses use the 28 polls with verified small-group identifiers; 3 others enter the broader appendix estimate. Control comparisons use the same canonical participant and score tables, restricting to the studies with observed control answers. Appendix C gives the questions and scoring rules.

The control groups differ in how they were formed. America in One Room and its 2021 climate successor interviewed a separate random sample that was never invited (Fishkin et al. 2021). The poll on antimicrobial resistance, held online in Brazil, Colombia, India, Indonesia, Nigeria and Tanzania, randomized panel members after the first interview; the release contains the controls and the invitees who attended, but not the invitees who stayed home (Mendelson et al. 2026). Northern Ireland interviewed 150 controls at T3, when 93 participants also returned; the controls have no T1 knowledge answers, so only a T3 cross-sectional comparison is possible. These are comparisons of attendees with controls, so selection into attendance remains possible. Poll metadata and reconstructed respondent answers come from dp-data, whose exports resolve duplicate Primaries rows and mark implausible ages missing.

For the three polls with common baselines, we compare attendees with controls using both a T2 regression adjusted for T1 and a difference in T2-minus-T1 gains. The Northern Ireland contrast compares T3 scores; its standard error clusters attendees by discussion group and treats controls as separate clusters.

4 Measuring Learning

We measure knowledge by closed-ended knowledge questions, mostly multiple choice, in some cases extracted from party or candidate placements, and in a few cases true-false (Luskin 1987; Luskin and Bullock 2005; Price 1999; Mondak 1999, 2001). Appendix C lists the items. Correct responses are scored as 1, incorrect responses and “don’t knows” as 0 (Luskin and Bullock 2011), and these scores are then averaged across items to give the proportion answered correctly.

Table 1 models T2 knowledge conditional on T1 knowledge. Writing the outcome as $K_2 - K_1$ while retaining K_1 gives the same fit and the same coefficients for every other regressor; only the

coefficient on K_1 falls by one. An unadjusted change-score model instead fixes the coefficient on K_1 in the T2 equation at one. It asks whether covariates predict the raw score difference, whereas Table 1 compares participants with the same measured starting score. The approaches can disagree when groups differ at baseline (Allison 1990; van Breukelen 2006). The observed score has a ceiling, and guessing and measurement error complicate its relationship to learning of the underlying facts (Luskin et al. 2016). We therefore treat the T1 coefficient as an association between measured scores, not an estimate of how prior knowledge causes learning.

Closed-ended items invite guessing, which can hide learning in the difference between observed scores. We fit the item-level latent class model of Cor and Sood (2016) to all 31 polls. It estimates the share who learned each question by allowing a correct answer to come from either knowledge or guessing, assuming knowledge is not lost between waves. We average its estimates across each poll’s questions and bootstrap respondents to measure sampling error. In the main 28-poll sample, the pooled guessing-adjusted gain is .180 [.145, .215], compared with the observed gain of .136 [.108, .163]. The two pooled results appear in Figure 1; Appendix Table A3 gives the broader 31-poll estimates. Table 1 retains respondent-level observed scores. The available joint person-level model in `guess` assigns one knowledge trajectory to each respondent across all questions, ruling out knowing one fact while learning another; its posterior is not a suitable outcome for this regression.

5 How Much Do Participants Learn, and Does Participating Cause It?

Figure 1 shows the observed attendee gain in the 28 polls with verified group identifiers and both pooled observed and guessing-adjusted gains. Its second panel shows control comparisons: T1-adjusted T2 differences in three polls, their pooled result, the climate poll’s T3 follow-up, and Northern Ireland’s T3-only contrast. The antimicrobial-resistance control study has no group identifier, so it enters that comparison but not the main attendee-gain pool. Northern Ireland uses the control group’s T3 standard deviation because its controls have no baseline knowledge answers.

Every poll shows learning. In the main sample, raw gains range from .012 to .288 of the items; pooled, the proportion correct rose by .136 [.108, .163], or .63 [.51, .75] standard deviations. The guessing-adjusted pooled estimate is .83 [.69, .97] on the same T1 standard-deviation scale. The pooling is a Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis: each poll’s mean gain is its true gain plus sampling error, true gains are normally distributed around an overall mean, the prior on the mean is flat and that on the between-poll standard deviation half-normal with scale .1 (Röver 2020). Face-to-face polls produced about twice the observed gain of online ones (.155 [.127, .184] against .077 [.028, .126]; Appendix Table A3).

A pre-post gain alone does not show that deliberation taught anything: participants take the same quiz twice and live through weeks of news. The control groups provide a benchmark. Adjusting for T1 knowledge, attendees scored .142 (.012) higher in proportion correct in America in One Room, .121 (.008) higher in the 2021 climate poll, and .125 (.009) higher in the antimicrobial-resistance poll, where the country estimates range from -.04 in Tanzania to .31 in Nigeria. Pooled, the adjusted difference is .49 [.36, .62] standard deviations. A year after the climate poll, attendees still scored .055 higher than controls (s.e. .010), 45% of the immediate adjusted difference. The controls gained .01, .03 and .02 of the items in the three studies.

The antimicrobial-resistance poll randomized invitations, but its treated group here is the attendees, who were 23 to 92% of invitees depending on the country. Attendees gained .125 of the items

and randomized controls .022; the difference in changes is .103 (.010). This comparison includes selection into attendance. The two American polls likewise compare attendees with separately drawn, uninvited controls. In America in One Room, attendees answered .458 of T1 items correctly against .378 for invitees who stayed home; in the climate poll the figures were .686 and .579. Their differences in changes are .131 (.012) and .093 (.009), respectively. Adjusting for T1 and comparing changes impose different restrictions on baseline differences; neither resolves selection into attendance. In Northern Ireland, returning attendees scored .177 (.028) more of the T3 items correctly than controls. This is an unadjusted cross-sectional difference: the controls had no T1 knowledge battery, and event attendance was self-selected.

6 Who Learns?

6.1 Regressors and hypotheses

The main model uses variables built consistently from the paired item answers and group identifiers: initial knowledge, groupmates' initial knowledge, group size, mode, and poll mean initial knowledge. Appendix B develops additional hypotheses for education, demographics, attitudes, and briefing reading and reports the corresponding historical-poll models.

Initial knowledge (K_1). The information-rich tend to get information-richer. The more one knows going in, the more one tends to learn and thus know going out. Absent ceiling effects, the coefficient should be > 1 ; given them, it may be < 1 . Prior knowledge on a particular topic improves people's ability to comprehend new information, enabling them to extract the central elements of a message and draw appropriate inferences efficiently (Eckhardt et al. 1991; Recht and Leslie 1988). Prior knowledge also enhances people's ability to store new information on that topic and retrieve it later (Cooke et al. 1993; Fiske et al. 1990; Hambrick 2003; McGraw and Pinney 1990; Recht and Leslie 1988; Schneider et al. 1993). So the less political information individuals have stored in memory, the more difficult it is for them to acquire new information.

Mode. Online deliberation, with its thinner exposure to other participants, may be, either intrinsically or at least in its current instantiations, a somewhat etiolated version of the face-to-face treatment (Luskin et al. 2006). It is therefore plausible that people learn less from online deliberations.

Observed group size. We count group members with paired item answers. This is a lower bound on actual group size when a member lacks one of the interviews. Larger groups may offer more perspectives but give each participant less time to speak (Latané et al. 1979).

Group knowledge. Participants may learn more from the other members of their small group when the latter know more. The other members' mean T1 score measures their overall knowledge. Their mean correctness on the particular items a participant missed at T1 measures knowledge that could fill that participant's gaps. We add this targeted measure alongside the overall group mean in a supplementary model. Participants who missed no T1 items receive zero on the targeted measure and a separate indicator for having no missed items.

Issue salience. More salient issues, to which many participants have already given some attention, exhibit decidedly less net attitude change (Luskin et al. 2007) and fall shorter of single-peakedness (List et al. 2013). We suspect they also, and relatedly, show less learning: there is less left to learn. We proxy salience by the participants' mean T1 knowledge.

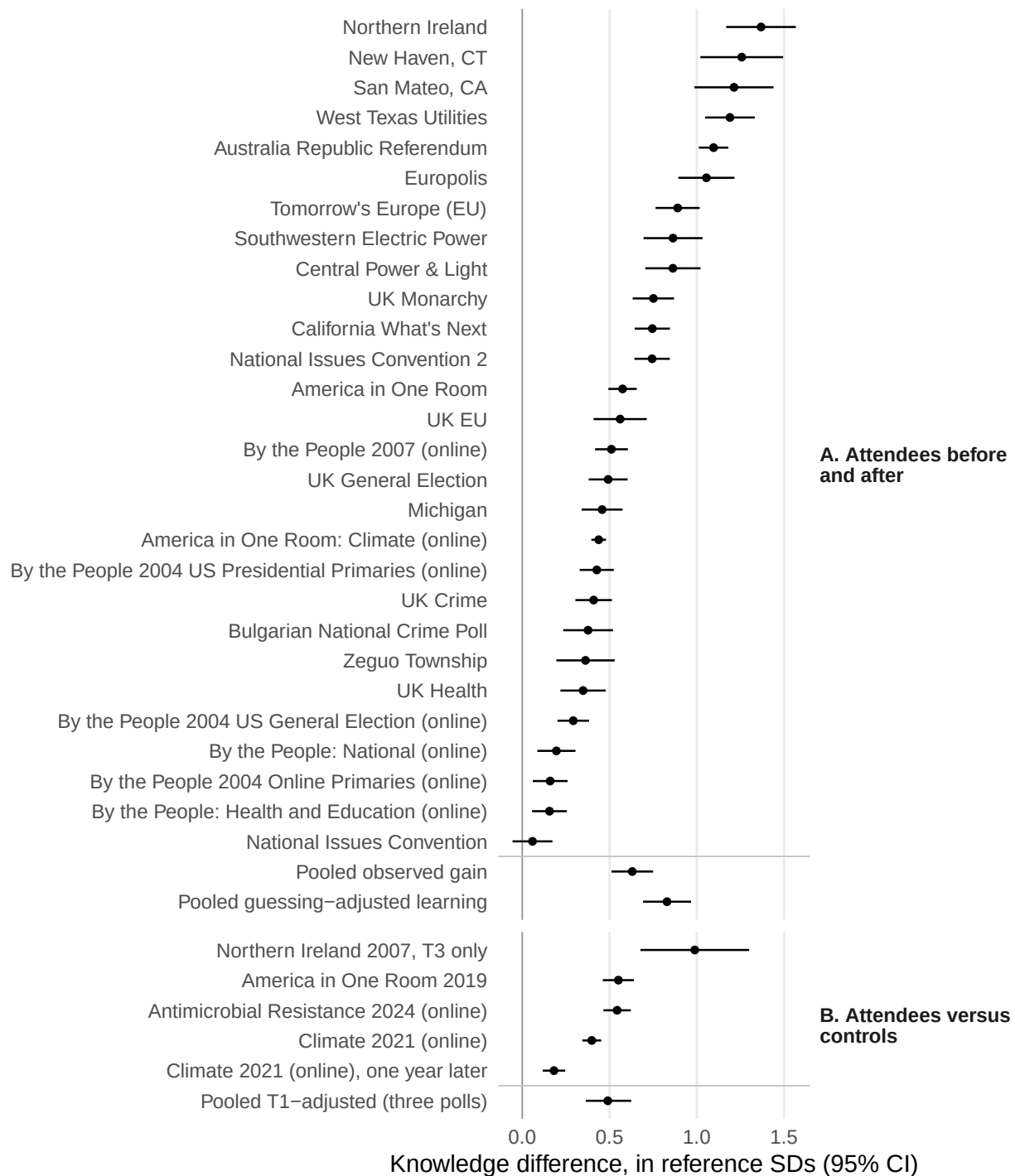


Figure 1: Knowledge gains and attendee-control differences, with 95% intervals. A: observed attendee T2 minus T1 gain in 28 polls with verified group identifiers and pooled observed and guessing-adjusted learning, scaled by each poll's T1 standard deviation. B: T1-adjusted T2 attendee-control differences in three polls and their pooled estimate, plus the climate T3 follow-up; these use the control group's T1 standard deviation. Northern Ireland is an unadjusted T3 contrast, scaled by the control group's T3 standard deviation and excluded from the pooled control estimate. Antimicrobial Resistance has no group identifier and enters only panel B here. Pooled estimates use Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis.

6.2 Model

The nested structure of the data, with individuals clustered in small groups clustered in polls, suggests a hierarchical linear model (Raudenbush and Bryk 2002) with random intercepts by small group and poll:

$$K_{igd2} = \beta_0 + \alpha_g + \gamma_d + \mathbf{x}'_{igd}\beta + u_{igd},$$

where i , g and d index individuals, small groups and polls; $\alpha_g \sim N(0, \sigma_\alpha^2)$ and $\gamma_d \sim N(0, \sigma_\gamma^2)$ are unmodeled parts of the intercept; $\mathbf{x}_{igd}$ holds initial knowledge, the other group members' mean T1 knowledge, group size, online mode, and the poll mean T1 score; and $u_{igd} \sim N(0, \sigma_u^2)$ is a disturbance. We estimate it by maximum likelihood (Bates et al. 2015). The main model uses 8,800 participants in 592 groups in 28 polls. Of the 31 polls with paired item answers, Denmark and Vermont lack verified group rosters, while the antimicrobial-resistance release lacks small-group IDs. Appendix Table A5 reports a richer specification on the 21 historical polls where additional covariates can be measured.

6.3 Who knows more after deliberation?

Table 1: T2 proportion correct conditional on T1 in 28 polls with verified small groups. Maximum likelihood coefficients (standard errors).

	Group-linked sample
Intercept	.192 (.038)
T1 knowledge	.510 (.010)
Paired respondents in group	-.001 (.001)
Groupmates' mean T1	.062 (.037)
Online	-.071 (.028)
Poll mean T1	.378 (.091)
Participants	8,800
Small groups	592
Polls	28
Marginal R-squared	0.393
Conditional R-squared	0.444

Notes. Scores come from respondent-level item answers in the canonical dp-data panel. Groupmates' mean T1 excludes the respondent herself; both that mean and group size use members with paired item answers. The model has poll and small-group random intercepts. Marginal R^2 covers fixed effects; conditional R^2 includes random intercepts. The richer historical-poll and reading-report models appear in Appendix Table A5.

Table 1 shows that participants with higher T1 scores also score higher at T2 (.510 (.010)), but the coefficient below one corresponds to smaller observed gains at higher T1 scores. The score ceiling and measurement error complicate an interpretation as differences in actual learning. The coefficient on groupmates' mean T1 is .062 (.037); its interval includes zero. Participants in online polls score lower at T2 (-.071 (.028)), conditional on T1, and those in polls whose participants start out knowing more score higher (.378 (.091)). In the historical-poll model, a bachelor's degree is associated with a T2 advantage at the lowest baseline score (.192 (.018)), which narrows as T1 knowledge rises (-.094 (.032) per unit). In the nine polls with a reading report, those who said

they read more of the briefing materials scored higher at T2 (.059 (.011)), though reading is itself a choice (Appendix Table A5).

6.4 Whom participation helps most

The control-group studies also let us ask whether the adjusted attendee-control difference varies across participants. Adding the product of attendance and centred T1 knowledge, the difference is smaller for those who start knowing more, by $-.15$ (.04) per unit of T1 knowledge in America in One Room and $-.25$ (.03) in the climate poll; the antimicrobial-resistance estimate is smaller and less precise (Appendix Table A4). Part of this pattern may be the ceiling: those who start high have less room to show a gain. The adjusted difference is also larger for those without a bachelor's degree in the climate and antimicrobial-resistance polls ($-.047$ (.016) and $-.043$ (.020)), though not in America in One Room. These comparisons can also reflect selection into attendance.

6.5 Do small groups matter?

If participants learn from each other, those placed with more knowledgeable groupmates should learn more. A causal interpretation requires groupmates' characteristics to be unrelated to one's own, as random assignment would imply. We test this by regressing each participant's characteristic on the mean among the other members of the group, controlling for the mean among the other members of the poll, without which the test is biased toward finding negative sorting (Guryan et al. 2009). Across the 28 group-linked polls, the T1 knowledge balance coefficient is .068 (.028) and the gender coefficient is $-.012$ (.020). In the 21 historical polls with the needed covariates, the age coefficient is $-.004$ (.024) and the bachelor's-degree coefficient is .038 (.023). The positive T1 balance coefficient in the expanded sample indicates some sorting of more knowledgeable participants into more knowledgeable groups. We therefore describe the peer estimates as associations, without a causal interpretation.

The group comparisons remain informative descriptively. Within each of 28 polls with group identifiers, we regress T2 knowledge on the other members' mean T1 knowledge, controlling for one's own and the poll's, and pool the estimates (Figure 2). The pooled association is .046 [-0.054, .150]: its upper interval endpoint corresponds to 1.5 points more on T2 for a ten-point difference in groupmates' T1 scores. The share of women in the group has no detectable association either (.007 [-.035, .048]). In the historical-poll sample, groupmates' knowledge on items each participant missed also has no detectable association when included alongside the overall peer mean (Appendix Table A5). Group knowledge measured after the deliberation could show a spurious association: groupmates' T2 answers reflect the experience they shared with the participant (Manski 1993).

7 Conclusion

Participants in Deliberative Polls gain factual knowledge, and attendees in the three polls with common baseline interviews score higher than controls after adjusting for T1. Northern Ireland's T3-only comparison points in the same direction but lacks baseline knowledge for controls. Much of the adjusted gap lasts in the one poll with a year-later interview. Within the participant samples, observed gains are larger among those who start out knowing less. Groupmates' initial knowledge has no detectable adjusted association with T2 scores in the expanded group-linked sample; baseline sorting limits a causal reading.

The attendee-control comparisons can reflect selection into attendance, even where invitations were

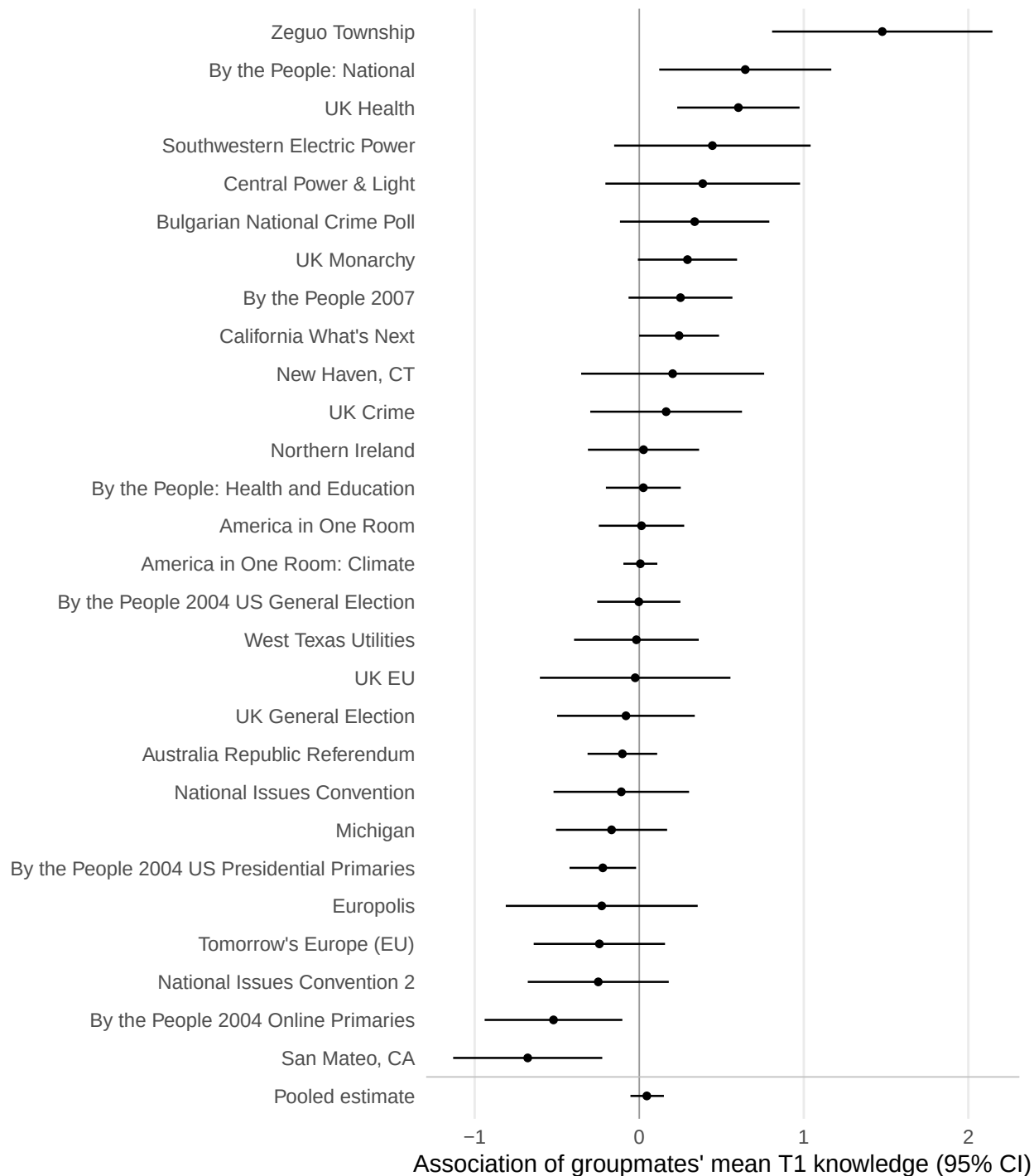


Figure 2: Association between the other group members' mean T1 knowledge and own T2 knowledge, by poll, with 95% intervals. Each estimate controls for own T1 knowledge and the poll's leave-one-out mean, with standard errors clustered by small group; the pooled estimate is from a Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis. Baseline knowledge sorting makes these associations descriptive.

randomized. The knowledge items are few and chosen by the organizers, so the gains concern facts the event emphasized.

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A The Deliberative Polls

All 31 polls with respondent-level knowledge items enter the broader before-and-after analysis. The 28 polls with verified discussion-group identifiers enter the main attendee analysis and Table 1. Four provide control comparisons, including Northern Ireland’s T3-only contrast; Antimicrobial Resistance has no group identifier.

Table A1: Polls with respondent-level knowledge-item answers at both waves.

Poll	Year	Mode	Group model	Control
UK Crime	1994	In person	Yes	No
UK EU	1995	In person	Yes	No
Central Power & Light	1996	In person	Yes	No
National Issues Convention	1996	In person	Yes	No
Southwestern Electric Power	1996	In person	Yes	No
UK Monarchy	1996	In person	Yes	No
West Texas Utilities	1996	In person	Yes	No
UK General Election	1997	In person	Yes	No
UK Health	1998	In person	Yes	No
Australia Republic Referendum	1999	In person	Yes	No
Denmark: Euro	2000	In person	No	No
Bulgarian National Crime Poll	2002	In person	Yes	No
New Haven, CT	2002	In person	Yes	No
By the People: National	2003	Online	Yes	No
National Issues Convention 2	2003	In person	Yes	No
By the People 2004 Online Primaries	2004	Online	Yes	No
By the People 2004 US General Election	2004	Online	Yes	No
By the People 2004 US Presidential Primaries	2004	Online	Yes	No
By the People: Health and Education	2005	Online	Yes	No
Zeguo Township	2005	In person	Yes	No
By the People 2007	2007	Online	Yes	No
Northern Ireland	2007	In person	Yes	Yes
Tomorrow’s Europe (EU)	2007	In person	Yes	No
Vermont Energy	2007	In person	No	No
San Mateo, CA	2008	In person	Yes	No
Europolis	2009	In person	Yes	No
Michigan	2009	In person	Yes	No
California What’s Next	2011	In person	Yes	No
America in One Room	2019	In person	Yes	Yes
America in One Room: Climate	2021	Online	Yes	Yes
Antimicrobial Resistance	2024	Online	No	Yes

B Further results

Table A2: T2 minus T1 attendee knowledge gains across all 31 item-linked polls, in proportions correct. Estimates with bootstrap standard errors for guessing adjustment.

Poll	Observed gain	Guessing adjusted
America in One Room	.143 (.010)	.174 (.011)
America in One Room: Climate	.122 (.006)	.167 (.008)
Antimicrobial Resistance	.125 (.007)	.156 (.009)
Australia Republic Referendum	.240 (.009)	.338 (.022)
Bulgarian National Crime Poll	.093 (.018)	.129 (.025)
By the People 2004 Online Primaries	.027 (.015)	.044 (.011)
By the People 2004 US General Election	.069 (.011)	.094 (.012)
By the People 2004 US Presidential Primaries	.118 (.014)	.148 (.017)
By the People 2007	.112 (.011)	.132 (.011)
By the People: Health and Education	.035 (.012)	.049 (.012)
By the People: National	.035 (.010)	.047 (.010)
California What's Next	.214 (.015)	.321 (.025)
Central Power & Light	.161 (.015)	.203 (.015)
Denmark: Euro	.220 (.011)	.334 (.021)
Europolis	.166 (.013)	.194 (.015)
Michigan	.098 (.013)	.123 (.015)
National Issues Convention	.012 (.012)	.051 (.014)
National Issues Convention 2	.123 (.009)	.150 (.010)
New Haven, CT	.223 (.021)	.280 (.030)
Northern Ireland	.286 (.021)	.328 (.025)
San Mateo, CA	.172 (.016)	.196 (.017)
Southwestern Electric Power	.203 (.020)	.301 (.023)
Tomorrow's Europe (EU)	.166 (.012)	.223 (.015)
UK Crime	.095 (.012)	.150 (.013)
UK EU	.161 (.022)	.208 (.027)
UK General Election	.103 (.012)	.182 (.016)
UK Health	.079 (.015)	.110 (.020)
UK Monarchy	.146 (.012)	.217 (.019)
Vermont Energy	.379 (.018)	.434 (.020)
West Texas Utilities	.288 (.018)	.358 (.023)
Zeguo Township	.112 (.026)	.141 (.030)

Table A3: Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis of observed and guessing-adjusted gains in the 28-poll main sample and all 31 item-linked polls, in proportions of knowledge items

Model	Parameter	Median	2.5%	97.5%
Observed pooled	Mean gain	.136	.108	.163
Observed pooled	Between-poll SD	.071	.053	.094
Observed by mode	Face-to-face	.155	.127	.184
Observed by mode	Online	.077	.028	.126
Observed by mode	Between-poll SD	.063	.046	.084
Guessing adjusted pooled	Mean gain	.180	.145	.215
Guessing adjusted pooled	Between-poll SD	.089	.066	.117
Observed all 31	Mean gain	.145	.115	.176
Observed all 31	Between-poll SD	.082	.062	.106
Guessing adjusted all 31	Mean gain	.192	.155	.229
Guessing adjusted all 31	Between-poll SD	.100	.076	.129

Table A4: Heterogeneous effects of participation. Each row adds the product of treatment and the moderator to the regression of T2 on treatment and T1 knowledge.

Study	Moderator	Treatment x moderator	n
America in One Room 2019	T1 knowledge (centred)	-.155 (.041)	1,367
America in One Room 2019	Bachelor’s degree	.027 (.023)	1,367
America in One Room: Climate 2021	T1 knowledge (centred)	-.252 (.029)	1,633
America in One Room: Climate 2021	Bachelor’s degree	-.047 (.016)	1,633
Antimicrobial Resistance 2024	T1 knowledge (centred)	.043 (.038)	2,419
Antimicrobial Resistance 2024	Bachelor’s degree	-.043 (.020)	2,408

B.1 Additional historical-poll covariates

Education. Education, qua years of schooling, is distinct from, and only moderately correlated with, political knowledge. Controlling for cognitive ability, with which it is more strongly correlated, its effect on knowledge appears negligible (Luskin 1990). But absent a separate measure of cognitive ability, it can roughly proxy the latter. Naturally, we expect it to have a positive effect. There may, however, be some mutual substitution with initial knowledge. People who know enough already may not need to be as bright to learn a lot, and people who are bright enough may not need to know as much to do so. We measure education as comparably as possible across polls in three categories: less than high school graduation, high school graduation, and a bachelor’s degree or more.

Gender and age. These demographic variables exhibit real-world political knowledge gaps, with men knowing more than women and older people more than younger ones (Delli Carpini and Keeter 1996). Age is measured in decades and gender as a dummy scored 1 for women.

Proportion of women. Whether from greater comfort, more widely shared cognitive or communication style, or lower stereotype threat (Steele 1997), women may learn more in small groups containing more women. We calculate the proportion excluding the participant herself.

Heterogeneity of opinion. In the real world, people often know congenial but not uncongenial

facts—those commonly cited by those sharing their views but not those commonly cited by those holding opposing views. Part of deliberation’s effect on learning may consist in getting people to note and accept (if, in many cases, still argue around) uncongenial facts. This can be expected to occur mainly on site. Participants learn a great deal in anticipation of the event, but the learning at that stage is mainly of congenial facts (Hansen 2004). On site, the participants find it harder to avoid confronting the uncongenial ones. This may happen more, the more opposing points of view are represented and argued in the small group—the more attitudinally heterogeneous the group is. We gauge this as the generalized variance, the determinant of the covariance matrix, of the group’s policy attitudes (Anderson 2003).

Attitude extremity. Participants starting with more extreme views may have shuttered out more uncongenial facts, leaving them with more ground for deliberation to make up. We measure extremity as the mean, across attitude indices j , of $|A_{ij} - .5|$, where A_{ij} is the i th respondent’s score on the j th index.

Reading the briefing materials. One of the main information vectors is the briefing document sent to participants shortly after recruitment, normally well in advance of the on-site deliberations. It provides some background facts and lays out the major arguments for and against given policy options, which embed additional facts congenial to each argument. Respondent-linked reading reports are available for nine polls: National Issues Convention, National Issues Convention 2, Tomorrow’s Europe, San Mateo, Australia, Central Power & Light, Southwestern Electric Power, West Texas Utilities, and Europolis. We score their ordered categories from zero to one using the source-specific response scales and analyze them in a separate model. Comparable reports have not been recovered for the other polls in the group-linked analysis.

B.2 Historical-poll models

Table A5: Supplementary historical-poll models of T2 proportion correct conditional on T1. Maximum likelihood coefficients (standard errors).

	Historical polls	Reading reports
Intercept	.071 (.050)	.513 (.068)
T1 knowledge	.475 (.025)	.514 (.091)
High school	.119 (.016)	.138 (.033)
BA or more	.192 (.018)	.206 (.034)
T1 x high school	-.041 (.030)	-.168 (.094)
T1 x BA or more	-.094 (.032)	-.176 (.094)
Age (decades)	-.003 (.002)	-.008 (.003)
Attitude extremity	-.077 (.030)	-.186 (.039)
Paired respondents in group	.000 (.001)	-.001 (.002)
Groupmates’ mean T1	.074 (.052)	-.066 (.075)
Opinion heterogeneity	.010 (.090)	.002 (.134)
Female	-.017 (.023)	-.051 (.034)
Group share women	-.007 (.035)	-.039 (.051)
Female x group share women	.022 (.045)	.065 (.064)
Online	-.102 (.032)	
Poll mean T1	.514 (.103)	
Briefing reading		.059 (.011)

Participants	5,758	2,643
Small groups	397	191
Polls	21	9
Marginal R-squared	0.387	0.405
Conditional R-squared	0.434	0.413

Notes. The historical-poll model includes poll and small-group random intercepts; the reading-reports model uses poll fixed effects and small-group random intercepts. Adding groupmates' T1 correctness on questions the respondent missed to the historical-poll model gives -.042 (.032) among 5,758 participants. Respondents with no missed T1 items receive zero on this measure and a separate indicator (-.024 (.023)); none is removed for lack of an opportunity to learn. Marginal R^2 covers fixed effects; conditional R^2 includes random intercepts.

C Knowledge items

The catalog contains 245 distinct baseline questions in 31 polls. The item definitions and source references are maintained in `dp-data/metadata/items.csv`; this appendix is generated from that file. Wording is paraphrased where only source labels survive. Choices are transcribed where recoverable; Northern Ireland's archived choice labels are truncated, while the retained climate and antimicrobial-resistance reports omit them. A code in brackets identifies the scored baseline answer, and notes describe open-response coding.

C.1 UK Crime (1994)

- **Can British courts sentence a murderer to death?** (true/false; source kw11). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Does Britain have the largest prison population in Western Europe?** (true/false; source kw21). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Does Britain have more prisoners serving life sentences than the rest of the European Community combined?** (true/false; source kw31). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Can a defendant be tried by jury in a local magistrates court?** (true/false; source kw41). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Is the number of members of Parliament about 100?** (true/false; source pkw11). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Is the longest permitted interval between general elections four years?** (true/false; source pkw21). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Is the British electoral system based on proportional representation?** (true/false; source pkw31). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].

C.2 UK EU (1995)

- **Has the European Union recently expanded to 15 members?** (true/false; source eusize1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Is Switzerland about to join the European Union?** (true/false; source swiss1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].

- **Are British income tax rates decided in Brussels?** (true/false; source `inctax1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Are European Parliament elections held every five years?** (true/false; source `elect1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Are the Liberal Democrats the least favorable to the European Union of the three main British parties?** (true/false; source `ptyapp1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].

C.3 Central Power & Light (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of CPL electricity?** (multiple choice; source `source1`). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Natural Gas [3].
- **Which customer group uses the most CPL electricity?** (multiple choice; source `use1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Industrial [3].
- **Which CPL customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source `rt1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Commerical [2].
- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source `smog1`). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source `setrt1`). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_utilities.R`.
- **How much profit do Texas electric utilities make on fuel?** (multiple choice; source `profit1`). Choices: 0: 0% | 1: 10% | 2: 20% | 3: 30% | 99: dk. Scored correct: 0% [0].
- **How much of the electric bill pays for fuel?** (multiple choice; source `pctful1`). Choices: 1: less than 20% | 2: 21-30% | 3: 31-40% | 4: 41-50% | 5: More Than 50% | 99: dk. Scored correct: 21-30% [2].

C.4 National Issues Convention (1996)

- **About what percentage of American children are born outside marriage?** (open numeric; source `WEDLOCK1`). Scored correct: 25-40 inclusive [25-40 inclusive]. Numeric response scored correct when within the inclusive interval shown in `correct_codes`; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_nic.R`.
- **About what percentage of children live in single-parent households?** (open numeric; source `AFDC1`). Scored correct: 1-10 inclusive [1-10 inclusive]. Numeric response scored correct when within the inclusive interval shown in `correct_codes`; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_nic.R`.
- **What was the unemployment rate over the previous ten years?** (open numeric; source `UNEMP1`). Scored correct: 5-10 inclusive [5-10 inclusive]. Numeric response scored

correct when within the inclusive interval shown in `correct_codes`; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_nic.R`.

- **Which listed purpose does the United States spend the most on?** (multiple choice; source `SPEND1`). Choices: 1: The space program | 2: Foreign aid | 3: National defense | 4: Agriculture subsidies | 8: Do not know. Scored correct: National defense [3].
- **Which listed country does the United States trade with most?** (multiple choice; source `TRADE1`). Choices: 1: Canada | 2: Japan | 3: Germany | 4: Mexico | 8: Do not know. Scored correct: Canada [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Iraq in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source `TROOPSA1`). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Somalia in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source `TROOPSB1`). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Rwanda in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source `TROOPSC1`). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: No [0].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Bosnia in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source `TROOPSD1`). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Where were Republicans on the liberal to conservative scale?** (placement scale; source `POLREP1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Slightly conservative | Conservative | Extremely conservative [5|6|7].
- **Where were Democrats on the liberal to conservative scale?** (placement scale; source `POLDEM1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Extremely liberal | Liberal | Slightly liberal [1|2|3].

C.5 Southwestern Electric Power (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of SWEPCO electricity?** (multiple choice; source `SOURCE1`). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [1].
- **Which customer group uses the most SWEPCO electricity?** (multiple choice; source `USE1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Industrial [3].
- **Which SWEPCO customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source `RT1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Residential [1].
- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source `SMOG1`). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source `SETRT1`). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_utilities.R`.

C.6 UK Monarchy (1996)

- **Is Princess Anne next in line to the throne?** (true/false; source Q5A). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Is the prime minister, rather than the Queen, Britain's head of state?** (true/false; source Q5B). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Is the Queen head of the Commonwealth?** (true/false; source Q5C). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is it the Queen's duty to decide the date of a general election?** (true/false; source Q5D). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Does a prime minister take office only after being asked by the Queen?** (true/false; source Q5E). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is the Queen head of the Church of England?** (true/false; source Q5F). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is the Queen head of the Church of Scotland?** (true/false; source Q5G). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Does Britain have an unwritten constitution?** (true/false; source Q5H). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **If a British monarch dies, who succeeds them?** (multiple choice; source Q8A). Choices: 1: 1 brother or sister | 2: 2 eldest brother | 3: 3 eldest sister | 4: 4 eldest child | 5: 5 eldest son | 6: 6 eldest daughter | 7: 7 none of these | 8: 8 can't choose | 9: 9 not answered. Scored correct: 5 eldest son [5].

C.7 West Texas Utilities (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of WTU electricity?** (multiple choice; source SOURCE1). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Natural Gas [3].
- **Which customer group uses the most WTU electricity?** (multiple choice; source USE1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commercial | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Residential [1].
- **Which WTU customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source RT1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commercial | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Residential [1].
- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source SMOG1). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source SETRT1). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See R/respondent_utilities.R.

C.8 UK General Election (1997)

- **Had inflation been below five percent over the previous few years?** (true/false; source `inflat1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Did the Bank of England decide interest rates?** (true/false; source `intrst1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was unemployment in the United Kingdom higher than in Germany?** (true/false; source `ukempl1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Gov Do Nothing to Make Inc. = | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Gov Spend Less, Cut Taxes Lot | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wagec1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Yes Min. Wage | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source `euc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Keep Distance from E.U. | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstl1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Try Hard Make Inc. = [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxl1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Spend Lot, Tax lot [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wagel1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source `eul1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Unite with E.U. [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstd1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Try Hard Make Inc. = [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Spend Lot, Tax lot [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wageld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].

- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source euld1). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Unite with E.U. [5|6|7].

C.9 UK Health (1998)

- **Was the standard National Health Service prescription charge ten pounds?** (true/false; source soph1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Was the proportion of older people in Britain increasing?** (true/false; source sophb1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Had inflation-adjusted National Health Service spending doubled in the previous 20 years?** (true/false; source sophc1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Did most people use private medical treatment instead of the National Health Service?** (true/false; source sophd1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Did all British women receive free breast cancer screening from the National Health Service?** (true/false; source sophe1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Was cosmetic surgery never available through the National Health Service?** (true/false; source sophf1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].

C.10 Australia Republic Referendum (1999)

- **How was the Governor-General appointed under the existing monarchy?** (multiple choice; source qrole1). Choices: 1: CHOOSES GOV GENERAL | 2: NO ROLE | 3: APPTS ON RECOMMEND OF PARLIAMENT | 4: APPTS ON ADVICE OF P.M. (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: APPTS ON ADVICE OF P.M. (correct) [4].
- **Could the prime minister remove the proposed president?** (multiple choice; source rempres1). Choices: 1: ANYTIME W/O REPORT TO HOUSE | 2: ANYTIME W/ LATER HOUSE APPROVE (correct) | 3: AFTER FAIR TRIAL IN PARLIAMENT | 4: CAN-NOT REMOVE | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: ANYTIME W/ LATER HOUSE APPROVE (correct) [2].
- **Could the Governor-General dismiss the government?** (multiple choice; source ggrole1). Choices: 1: CONTROLS GOVERNMENT | 2: ACTS ON QUEEN'S INSTRUCTIONS | 3: PERFORMS ONLY CEREMONIAL DUTIES | 4: CAN DECIDE TO DISMISS GOVERNMENT (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: CAN DECIDE TO DISMISS GOVERNMENT (correct) [4].
- **Which existing office would the proposed president most resemble?** (multiple choice; source presrol1). Choices: 1: BRITISH PRIME MINISTER | 2: AUSTRALIAN PRIME MINISTER | 3: AMERICAN PRESIDENT | 4: GOVERNOR GENERAL (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: GOVERNOR GENERAL (correct) [4].
- **Which party was more concerned with social and welfare issues?** (multiple choice; source welfare1). Choices: 1: LIBERAL PARTY MORE | 2: EQUALLY CONCERNED | 3: LABOR PARTY MORE (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: NOT MUCH IMPRESSION/DONT KNOW. Scored correct: LABOR PARTY MORE (correct) [3].

- **Which party was closer to business?** (multiple choice; source `business1`). Choices: 1: LIBERAL PARTY MORE (correct) | 2: EQUALLY CLOSE | 3: LABOR PARTY MORE | 96: NONE | 97: NOT MUCH IMPRESSION/DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: LIBERAL PARTY MORE (correct) [1].
- **What public office did Aden Ridgeway hold?** (multiple choice; source `ridgeway1`). Choices: 1: LEADER OF FEDERAL OPPOSITION | 2: LEADER OF DEMOCRATS | 3: JUSTICE OF THE HIGH COURT | 4: ABORIGINAL SENATOR IN PARLIAMENT (correct) | 5: NONE OF THESE | 6: DONT KNOW | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: ABORIGINAL SENATOR IN PARLIAMENT (correct) [4].
- **What public office did Jennie George hold?** (multiple choice; source `jgeorge1`). Choices: 1: SECRETARY OF TEACHERS FEDERATION | 2: LABOR MEMBER OF FEDERAL PARLIAMENT | 3: LEADER OF WORKERS' UNION | 4: PRESIDENT OF ACTU (correct) | 5: NONE OF THESE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: PRESIDENT OF ACTU (correct) [4].
- **Would the Australian flag change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `flagchg1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].
- **Would the national anthem change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `anthem1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].
- **Would use of the word Royal in military service names change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `wdroya11`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: YES [2].
- **Would Australian participation in the Commonwealth Games change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `pargame1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].

C.11 Denmark: Euro (2000)

- **Could Denmark be fined for a large fiscal deficit as a member of the monetary union?** (multiple choice; source `s_18`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Could Denmark set its own interest rates after joining the monetary union?** (multiple choice; source `s_19`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Could Denmark set its own tax rates after joining the single currency?** (multiple choice; source `s_20`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Would a yes vote in September 2000 cause euro notes and coins to circulate in 2001?** (multiple choice; source `s_21`). Choices: 1: 2001 | 2: 2004 (korrekt svar) | 3: 2005 | 4: 2007 | 5: don't know. Scored correct: 2004 (korrekt svar) [2].
- **What would happen to the Danish National Bank if Denmark joined the single currency?** (multiple choice; source `s_22`). Choices: 1: be close down | 2: continue to operate pretty much like now | 3: become part of european central bank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: become part of european central bank [3].

- **Would euro coins have a national side?** (multiple choice; source `s_23`). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: no | 3: don't know. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Did the Socialist People's Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source `s_25_07`). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].
- **Did the Christian People's Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source `s_25_09`). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].
- **Did the Progress Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source `s_25_11`). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].

C.12 Bulgarian National Crime Poll (2002)

- **Could police detain a citizen for questioning at any hour without allowing refusal?** (true/false; source `q12_1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Could a court detain a suspect indefinitely while proving guilt?** (true/false; source `q12_2`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Could prosecutors detain a suspect until a case was resolved?** (true/false; source `q12_3`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was the chief prosecutor accountable to parliament?** (true/false; source `q12_4`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Were police forbidden to use violence against a detainee even if the person was guilty?** (true/false; source `q12_5`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Could police detain a person for 72 hours?** (true/false; source `q12_6`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was a confession alone insufficient to establish guilt?** (true/false; source `q12_7`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].

C.13 New Haven, CT (2002)

- **Which population estimate is closest to that of the greater New Haven region?** (multiple choice; source `pre_q35`). Choices: 1: 250,000 | 2: 350,000 | 3: 550,000 | 4: 750,000. Scored correct: 550,000 [3].
- **Was New Haven regional job growth in the 1990s greater than, similar to, or less than the rest of the United States?** (multiple choice; source `pre_q36`). Choices: 1: More | 2: About the same | 3: Less. Scored correct: About the same [2].
- **What is the main source of revenue for most town governments in greater New Haven?** (multiple choice; source `pre_q37`). Choices: 1: Sales taxes | 2: Property taxes | 3: State subsidies | 4: Federal subsidies. Scored correct: Property taxes [2].
- **Did the population of New Haven city increase, stay the same, or decrease in the 1990s?** (multiple choice; source `pre_q39`). Choices: 1: Increased | 2: Stayed the same | 3:

Decreased. Scored correct: Decreased [3].

- **Does Connecticut law allow communities to share property tax revenues?** (multiple choice; source pre_q40). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Do communities with the most valuable property tend to have the lowest, average, or highest property tax rates?** (multiple choice; source pre_q41). Choices: 1: Lowest | 2: Average | 3: Highest. Scored correct: Lowest [1].
- **How does the Federal Aviation Authority classify Tweed New Haven Airport?** (multiple choice; source pre_q42). Choices: 1: Major hub | 2: Medium hub | 3: Minor hub | 4: Non-hub. Scored correct: Non-hub [4].
- **Would maintaining Tweed New Haven Airport at its current level of service require significant investment?** (multiple choice; source pre_q43). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: No. Scored correct: Yes [1].

C.14 By the People: National (2003)

- **Where did the Democratic Party stand on a 0–10 scale from doing nothing about global warming to acting now?** (placement scale; source qb15b). Choices: 0–10 scale: 0 = do nothing | 5 = midway | 10 = act now. Scored correct: Above midpoint [6|7|8|9|10].
- **Where did the Republican Party stand on a 0–10 scale from doing nothing about global warming to acting now?** (placement scale; source qb15c). Choices: 0–10 scale: 0 = do nothing | 5 = midway | 10 = act now. Scored correct: Below midpoint [0|1|2|3|4].
- **Did President Bush want to increase, decrease, or maintain foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source qb26). Choices: 1: increase | 2: decrease | 3: keep it the same | 4: haven't heard anything about this. Scored correct: increase [1].
- **Did President Bush support recent international agreements to control greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source qb18). Choices: 1: supports | 2: opposes | 3: haven't heard anything about this. Scored correct: opposes [2].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to military spending?** (multiple choice; source qb40). Choices: 1: 1 dollar, | 2: 5 dollars, | 3: 10 dollars, | 4: 20 dollars, | 5: 30 dollars or more, or | 6: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 20 dollars, [4].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source qb41). Choices: 1: 1 dollar, | 2: 5 dollars, | 3: 10 dollars, | 4: 20 dollars, | 5: 30 dollars or more, or | 6: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 1 dollar, [1].
- **How much of each \$100 of United States output was sold abroad?** (multiple choice; source qb42). Choices: 1: 4 dollars worth, | 2: 8 dollars, | 3: 12 dollars, | 4: 24 dollars or more, or | 5: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 12 dollars, [3].
- **About how many adults per 100 in the most affected African countries had HIV/AIDS?** (multiple choice; source qb43). Choices: 1: fewer than 5 out of 100, | 2: about 10 of 100, | 3: about 20 of 100, | 4: 30 or more out of 100, or | 5: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 30 or more out of 100, or [4].

- **Did the United States have a veto over World Trade Organization decisions?** (multiple choice; source qb44). Choices: 1: true | 2: false. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Did the United States have a veto on the United Nations Security Council?** (multiple choice; source qb45). Choices: 1: true | 2: false. Scored correct: true [1].
- **What was the main cause of global warming?** (multiple choice; source qb12). Choices: 1: it is caused mostly by human activities, like driving cars a | 2: it is caused mostly by natural changes in the climate, | 3: it is not occurring at all, or | 4: haven't you thought much about this?. Scored correct: it is caused mostly by human activities, like driving cars a [1].

C.15 National Issues Convention 2 (2003)

- **Where did the Democratic Party stand on the global warming action scale?** (placement scale; source wrm3_b). Choices: 98: don't know. Scored correct: Above midpoint [6|7|8|9|10].
- **Where did the Republican Party stand on the global warming action scale?** (placement scale; source wrm3_c). Choices: 98: don't know. Scored correct: Below midpoint [0|1|2|3|4].
- **Did President Bush want to increase, decrease, or maintain foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source aid3). Choices: 1: increase | 2: decrease | 3: keep it the same | 4: haven't heard anything about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: increase [1].
- **Did President Bush support recent international agreements to control greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source wrm5). Choices: 1: supports | 3: opposes | 5: haven't heard anything about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: opposes [3].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to military spending?** (multiple choice; source kno1_a). Choices: 1: 1 dollar | 2: 5 dollars | 3: 10 dollars | 4: 20 dollars | 5: 30+ dollars | 6: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 20 dollars [4].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source kno1_b). Choices: 1: 1 dollar | 2: 5 dollars | 3: 10 dollars | 4: 20 dollars | 5: 30+ dollars | 6: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 1 dollar [1].
- **How much of each \$100 of United States output was sold abroad?** (multiple choice; source kno2_a). Choices: 1: 4 dollars | 2: 8 dollars | 3: 12 dollars | 4: 24+ dollars | 5: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 12 dollars [3].
- **About how many adults per 100 in the most affected African countries had HIV/AIDS?** (multiple choice; source kno2_b). Choices: 1: fewer than 5 out of 100 | 2: about 10 of 100 | 3: about 20 of 100 | 4: 30+ out of 100 | 5: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 30+ out of 100 [4].
- **Did the United States have a veto over World Trade Organization decisions?** (multiple choice; source kno3_a). Choices: 1: true | 5: false | 8: don't know. Scored correct: false [5].

- **Did the United States have a veto on the United Nations Security Council?** (multiple choice; source kno3_b). Choices: 1: true | 5: false | 8: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].
- **What was the main cause of global warming?** (multiple choice; source wrm1_b). Choices: 1: human activities | 2: natural changes | 3: not occurring at all | 4: haven't thought much about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: human activities [1].

C.16 By the People 2004 Online Primaries (2004)

- **What did President Bush's tax cut do to taxes on investment income?** (multiple choice; source b1q43). Choices: 1: lower it | 2: keep it the same | 3: raise it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: lower it [1].
- **What was Wesley Clark's most recent government position?** (multiple choice; source b1q44). Choices: 1: senator from arkansas | 2: secretary of the air force | 3: supreme allied commander of nato | 4: national security advisor to the president | 5: don't know. Scored correct: supreme allied commander of nato [3].
- **Why did President Bush end tariffs on imported steel?** (multiple choice; source b1q45). Choices: 1: the steel industry and steelworkers unions objected | 2: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o | 3: domestic steel production is insufficient to meet demand, th | 4: he has never supported tariffs | 5: don't know. Scored correct: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o [2].
- **Which Democratic presidential candidate had served as House majority leader?** (multiple choice; source b1q46). Choices: 1: john edwards | 2: howard dean | 3: joe lieberman | 4: richard gephardt | 5: don't know. Scored correct: richard gephardt [4].
- **How had the unemployment rate changed since President Bush took office?** (multiple choice; source b1q47). Choices: 1: decreased | 2: stayed about the same | 3: increased | 4: don't know. Scored correct: increased [3].
- **How many Americans had been killed in action in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source b1q48). Choices: 1: fewer than a hundred | 2: several hundred | 3: several thousand | 4: more than twenty thousand | 5: don't know. Scored correct: several hundred [2].
- **What was the Bush administration's position on a Free Trade Area of the Americas?** (multiple choice; source b1q49). Choices: 1: support it | 2: neither support nor oppose it | 3: oppose it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: support it [1].

C.17 By the People 2004 US General Election (2004)

- **How did John Kerry vote on the Senate resolution authorizing the Iraq war?** (multiple choice; source w4b60). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: vote for it | 2: vote against it | 3: not vote on it | 4: blank | 5: don't know. Scored correct: vote for it [1].
- **Which country harbored the most Al Qaeda and Taliban fighters?** (multiple choice; source w4b61). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: india | 2: pakistan | 3: sri lanka | 4: indonesia | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: pakistan [2].

- **Was Iraq directly involved in the September 11 attacks?** (multiple choice; source w4b62). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Had large quantities of weapons of mass destruction been found in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source w4b63). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Did prescription drugs cost more in Canada than in the United States?** (multiple choice; source w4b64). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **What was George W. Bush's role during the Vietnam War?** (multiple choice; source w4b65). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: he was drafted but never went to vietnam | 2: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam | 3: he was ineligible to serve in the military because of a medi | 4: he served in the texas air national guard | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: he served in the texas air national guard [4].
- **What was John Kerry's role during the Vietnam War?** (multiple choice; source w4b66). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: he was drafted but never went to vietnam | 2: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam | 3: he was ineligible to serve in the military because of a medi | 4: he served in the massachusetts air national guard | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam [2].
- **Which country was a major destination for offshore white-collar jobs?** (multiple choice; source w4b68). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: south africa | 2: japan | 3: brazil | 4: india | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: india [4].
- **About how many Americans had been killed in Iraq since the war began?** (multiple choice; source w4b69). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: 100 | 2: 500 | 3: 1,000 | 4: 10,000 | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: 1,000 [3].

C.18 By the People 2004 US Presidential Primaries (2004)

- **What did President Bush's tax cut do to taxes on investment income?** (multiple choice; source b1q43). Choices: 1: lower it | 2: keep it the same | 3: raise it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: lower it [1].
- **What was Wesley Clark's most recent government position?** (multiple choice; source b1q44). Choices: 1: senator from arkansas | 2: secretary of the air force | 3: supreme allied commander of nato | 4: national security advisor to the president | 5: don't know. Scored correct: supreme allied commander of nato [3].
- **Why did President Bush end tariffs on imported steel?** (multiple choice; source b1q45). Choices: 1: the steel industry and steelworkers unions objected | 2: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o | 3: domestic steel production is insufficient to meet demand, th | 4: he has never supported tariffs | 5: don't know. Scored correct: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o [2].

- **Which Democratic presidential candidate had served as House majority leader?** (multiple choice; source b1q46). Choices: 1: john edwards | 2: howard dean | 3: joe lieberman | 4: richard gephardt | 5: don't know. Scored correct: richard gephardt [4].
- **How had the unemployment rate changed since President Bush took office?** (multiple choice; source b1q47). Choices: 1: decreased | 2: stayed about the same | 3: increased | 4: don't know. Scored correct: increased [3].
- **How many Americans had been killed in action in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source b1q48). Choices: 1: fewer than a hundred | 2: several hundred | 3: several thousand | 4: more than twenty thousand | 5: don't know. Scored correct: several hundred [2].
- **What was the Bush administration's position on a Free Trade Area of the Americas?** (multiple choice; source b1q49). Choices: 1: support it | 2: neither support nor oppose it | 3: oppose it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: support it [1].

C.19 By the People: Health and Education (2005)

- **Where did the United States rank among wealthy countries in student mathematics skills?** (multiple choice; source q15). Choices: 1: bottom 3 | 2: bottom 10 | 3: top 10 | 4: top 3 | 7: dk. Scored correct: bottom 10 [2].
- **Had it become harder or easier for foreigners to get United States work permits?** (multiple choice; source q16). Choices: 1: harder | 2: same | 3: easier | 7: dk. Scored correct: harder [1].
- **Had the minority–White gap in elementary mathematics and reading scores widened?** (multiple choice; source q17). Choices: 1: increasing | 2: same | 3: decreasing | 7: dk. Scored correct: increasing [1].
- **About how many Americans lacked health insurance?** (multiple choice; source q26). Choices: 1: 1 million | 2: 25 million | 3: 45 million | 4: 65 million | 5: 85 million | 7: dk. Scored correct: 45 million [3].
- **How much was the population age 65 and older expected to grow over the next 50 years?** (multiple choice; source q27). Choices: 1: stay about the same | 2: increase by about half | 3: double | 4: triple | 7: dk. Scored correct: double [3].
- **What share of uninsured families had low incomes?** (multiple choice; source q28). Choices: 1: a quarter | 2: fifty per cent | 3: two thirds | 4: ninety per cent | 7: dk. Scored correct: two thirds [3].

C.20 Zeguo Township (2005)

- **By how much did Zeguo Township revenue increase from 2003 to 2004?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3043). Choices: 1: 10.2% | 2: 20.1% | 3: 33.7% | 4: No increase. Scored correct: 33.7% [3].
- **How large is the floating population in Zeguo Township?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3044). Choices: 1: 300,000 | 2: 50,000 | 3: 120,000 | 4: 200,000. Scored correct: 120,000 [3].

- **Which listed product is not a major product of Zeguo Township?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3045). Choices: 1: Water pumps | 2: Shoes | 3: Plastic products | 4: Air compressors. Scored correct: Plastic products [3].
- **How many parks does Zeguo Township currently have?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3046). Choices: 1: Zero | 2: One | 3: Two | 4: Five | 5: Seven. Scored correct: Two parks [3].

C.21 By the People 2007 (2007)

- **About how many Americans were prevented from voting because of criminal convictions?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q19). Choices: 1: 50,000 | 2: 500,000 | 3: 5,000,000 | 4: 15,000,000 | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: 5,000,000 [3].
- **What was the purpose of gerrymandering?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q20). Choices: 1: Increase electoral competition | 2: Ensure a majority for one party over another | 3: Include independents in the primary process | 4: Make them much smaller | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Ensure a majority for one party over another [2].
- **What share of eligible voters voted in the specified presidential election?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q21). Choices: 1: 10% | 2: 30% | 3: 50% | 4: 70% | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: 50% [3].
- **Which listed country had compulsory voting?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q22). Choices: 1: Ireland | 2: United Kingdom | 3: Australia | 4: South Korea | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Australia [3].
- **Who had to register with Selective Service in the United States?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q23). Choices: 1: Nobody | 2: Men between 18 and 25 years old | 3: Both men and women between 18 and 25 years old | 4: Men and women who receive federal grants for education | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Men between 18 and 25 years old [2].
- **What vote total must a United States presidential candidate receive to win?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q24). Choices: 1: Gets more votes than any other candidate | 2: Gets a majority of all the votes cast | 3: Gets more Electoral College votes than any other candidate | 4: Gets a majority of Electoral College votes | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Gets a majority of Electoral College votes [4].
- **How often are congressional districts redrawn?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q25). Choices: 1: Every 5 years | 2: Every 10 years | 3: Every 15 years | 4: Every 20 years | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Every 10 years [2].
- **Which two states held the earliest presidential primary events?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q26). Choices: 1: Nevada and South Carolina | 2: Iowa and New Hampshire | 3: Indiana and New Mexico | 4: Wyoming and Delaware | 5: Michigan and Florida | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Iowa and New Hampshire [2].

C.22 Northern Ireland (2007)

- **What share of Northern Ireland schools had mostly Protestant or mostly Catholic pupils?** (multiple choice; source t1q21). Choices: 1: more than 50% | 2: 40-50% | 3: 20-30% | 4: 5-10% | 5: less than 1% | 9: don't know. Scored correct: 5-10% [4]. Archived

variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.

- **By about what percentage had the number of children entering Omagh schools changed?** (multiple choice; source t1q22). Choices: 1: increased by 20% | 2: increased by 10% | 3: stayed about the same | 4: decreased by 10% | 5: decreased by 20% | 9: don't know. Scored correct: decreased by 10% [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did the new entitlement framework require for the school curriculum?** (multiple choice; source t1q23). Choices: 1: every school provides all 14-year-olds with a choice of at l | 2: every child has the right to attend any school his or her pa | 3: every child be provided a free school meal every school day | 4: every child receives free textbooks | 9: don't know. Scored correct: every school provides all 14-year-olds with a choice of at l... [1]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did the new entitlement framework require for access to courses?** (multiple choice; source t1q24). Choices: 1: every child receives tuition in the language of his or her p | 2: every child receives free transportation to and from school | 3: every denominational group has the right to run its own scho | 4: one-third of all the subjects offered must be applied | 9: don't know. Scored correct: one-third of all the subjects offered must be applied... [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did pupils in Northern Ireland typically do after compulsory schooling?** (multiple choice; source t1q25). Choices: 1: about one-quarter go directly into employment | 2: about one-quarter leave school to be unemployed | 3: about three-quarters of grammar school pupils attend univers | 4: about three-quarters of secondary school students attend fur | 9: don't know. Scored correct: about three-quarters of grammar school pupils attend univers... [3]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **Which statement about Northern Ireland school funding was correct?** (multiple choice; source t1q26). Choices: 1: schools receive more funding for older pupils | 2: schools receive the same funding for all pupils, regardless | 3: schools receive more funding for younger pupils | 9: don't know. Scored correct: schools receive more funding for older pupils [1]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **Which statement about the employing authority for Northern Ireland schools was correct?** (multiple choice; source t1q27). Choices: 1: the official employer for all teachers is the education and | 2: the official employer for all teachers is the department of | 3: the official employer for all teachers in catholic schools i | 4: the official employer for all teachers in voluntary grammar | 9: don't know. Scored correct: the official employer for all teachers in voluntary grammar... [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.

C.23 Tomorrow's Europe (EU) (2007)

- **Which listed country was an official candidate to join the European Union?** (multiple choice; source q16_1). Choices: 1: Romania | 2: Montenegro | 3: Croatia | 4: Morocco | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Croatia [3].
- **How were members of the European Parliament chosen?** (multiple choice; source q17_1). Choices: 1: Directly elected by the citizens of their country | 2: Elected for three year terms | 3: Elected by the parliament of their country | 4: Appointed by their national head of government | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Directly elected by the citizens of their country [1].
- **Which European Union institutions adopted employment laws?** (multiple choice; source q18_1). Choices: 1: The European Commission, in some cases with the European Parliament | 2: The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament | 3: The European Parliament by itself | 4: The European commission by itself | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament [2].
- **What was the European Union's role in unemployment benefits?** (multiple choice; source q19_1). Choices: 1: Finance the member states unemployment benefit systems | 2: Decide the level and length of unemployment benefits in the member states | 3: Require that the member states merge their unemployment benefit systems by 2010 | 4: Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live [4].
- **To what was roughly one-third of the European Union budget devoted?** (multiple choice; source q20_1). Choices: 1: Helping the EU's less prosperous regions | 2: Subsidizing the EU's fishing industry | 3: Financing diplomatic missions abroad | 4: Maintaining the EU's administration and bureaucracy | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Helping the EU's less prosperous regions [1].
- **How was the share of European Union adults age 65 or older expected to change by 2050?** (multiple choice; source q21_1). Choices: 1: About one quarter of what it is now | 2: About half of what it is now | 3: About the same as what it is now | 4: About twice what it is now | 5: About four times what it is now | 6: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: About twice what it is now [4].
- **How much foreign aid did the European Union and its members give relative to the United States?** (multiple choice; source q22_1). Choices: 1: The EU and its member states give roughly four times as much | 2: The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much | 3: The EU and its member states and the US give about the same amount | 4: The US gives roughly twice as much | 5: The US gives roughly four times as much | 6: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much [2].
- **About what share of European Union member governments' spending went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source q23_1). Choices: 1: About 1% | 2: About 5% | 3: About 9% | 4: About 13% | 5: About 17% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: About 1% [1].

- **Which listed country did not possess nuclear weapons?** (multiple choice; source q24_1). Choices: 1: Pakistan | 2: India | 3: North Korea | 4: Japan | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Japan [4].
- **Where was Nicolas Sarkozy on the left to right political scale?** (placement scale; source q33a_1). Choices: 1: 0 | 2: 1 | 3: 2 | 4: 3 | 5: 4 | 6: 5 | 7: 6 | 8: 7 | 9: 8 | 10: 9 | 11: 10 | 12: REF | 13: DK. Scored correct: 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 [7|8|9|10|11].
- **Where was Gordon Brown on the left to right political scale?** (placement scale; source q33b_1). Choices: 1: 0 | 2: 1 | 3: 2 | 4: 3 | 5: 4 | 6: 5 | 7: 6 | 8: 7 | 9: 8 | 10: 9 | 11: 10 | 12: REF | 13: DK. Scored correct: 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 [1|2|3|4|5].

C.24 Vermont Energy (2007)

- **What was the surcharge on Vermont electricity bills?** (multiple choice; source Q77). Choices: 1: Almost no impact | 2: Reduced by 20% | 3: Reduced by 50% | 4: Reduced by 70% | 5: Reduced by 90% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Reduced by 20% [2].
- **What was the effect of the Vermont energy-efficiency program?** (multiple choice; source Q78). Choices: 1: Almost no impact | 2: Reduced by 20% | 3: Reduced by 50% | 4: Reduced by 70% | 5: Reduced by 90% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Reduced by 50% [3].
- **What share of electricity came from renewable sources?** (multiple choice; source Q79). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 15% | 25% [2|3].
- **What share of electricity came from the Vermont Yankee nuclear plant?** (multiple choice; source Q80). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 40% [4].
- **What share of electricity came from Hydro-Québec?** (multiple choice; source Q81). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 15% [2].
- **What share of electricity was produced within Vermont?** (multiple choice; source Q82). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 25% [3].
- **How did Vermont electricity rates compare with the rest of New England?** (multiple choice; source Q83). Choices: 1: Roughly 10% higher | 2: Roughly 20% higher | 3: About the same | 4: Roughly 10% lower | 5: Roughly 20% lower | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Roughly 10% lower [4].
- **What was the average Vermont household electricity bill?** (multiple choice; source Q84). Choices: 1: Roughly \$60 | 2: Roughly \$80 | 3: Roughly \$120 | 4: Roughly \$180 | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Roughly \$80 [2].
- **When did the Vermont Yankee contract expire?** (multiple choice; source Q85). Choices: 1: 2010 | 2: 2012 | 3: 2018 | 4: 2025 | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 2012 [2].

C.25 San Mateo, CA (2008)

- **What was the yearly gap between new homes needed and homes built in San Mateo County?** (multiple choice; source Q19). Choices: 1: about 200 | 2: about 500 | 3: about 1,000 | 4: about 5,000 | 5: about 8,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: about 1,000 [3].
- **What was the median single-family home price in San Mateo County in 2007?** (multiple choice; source Q20). Choices: 1: 550,000 | 2: 680,000 | 3: 750,000 | 4: 830,000 | 5: 950,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 950,000 [5].
- **What share of county households could afford a median-priced home in 2006?** (multiple choice; source Q21). Choices: 1: 12% | 2: 23% | 3: 37% | 4: 43% | 5: 55% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 12% [1].
- **What was the average rent for a two-bedroom apartment in 2007?** (multiple choice; source Q22). Choices: 1: \$1,100 | 2: \$1,300 | 3: \$1,700 | 4: \$2,200 | 5: \$3,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: \$1,700 [3].
- **How much was county housing demand projected to grow from 2005 to 2025?** (multiple choice; source Q23). Choices: 1: 20,000 | 2: 40,000 | 3: 60,000 | 4: 70,000 | 5: 90,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 70,000 [4].
- **What share of projected new households would have low or very low incomes?** (multiple choice; source Q24). Choices: 1: Less than one-third | 2: Less than one-half | 3: About half | 4: More than one-half | 5: More than two-thirds | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: About half [3].
- **How many new homes were projected to be built at the current development rate?** (multiple choice; source Q25). Choices: 1: 25,000 | 2: 50,000 | 3: 75,000 | 4: 100,000 | 5: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 25,000 [1].
- **What share of county land was open space or other protected land?** (multiple choice; source Q26). Choices: 1: less than 25% | 2: 33% | 3: 58% | 4: 67% | 5: more than 75% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: more than 75% [5].

C.26 Europolis (2009)

- **V1Q43. Is the main decision-making body of the European Union the...?** (multiple choice; source V1Q43). Choices: 1: European Commission | 2: Council of Ministers | 3: European Parliament | 4: European Court of Auditors | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: Council of Ministers [2].
- **V1Q44. Only one of the following statements about the European Parliament is false. Which one is it?** (multiple choice; source V1Q44). Choices: 1: It passes all EU laws | 2: It can dismiss the European Commission | 3: It can reject the budget proposed by the Council of Minister | 4: It is involved in decisions about the admission of new Membe | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: It passes all EU laws [1].
- **V1Q46. Which of the following is true of Blue card workers?** (multiple choice; source V1Q46). Choices: 1: They can work anywhere in the EU | 2: They must have a university education | 3: They cannot bring family members to join them any faster tha | 4: They are

subject to the Returns Directive | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: They must have a university education [2].

- **V1Q47. Which of the following is true about the ways in which immigration policy is currently made?** (multiple choice; source V1Q47). Choices: 1: The EU sets the basic rules about entry and residency require | 2: The EU decides how many immigrants can be admitted to each country | 3: Work permits for immigrants must be approved by the EU | 4: The EU plays no role in immigration policy. | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: The EU sets the basic rules about entry and residency require [1].
- **V1Q49. The percentage of the EU's total energy consumption that comes from fossil fuels (coal, gas or oil) is about...?** (multiple choice; source V1Q49). Choices: 1: 50% | 2: 60% | 3: 70% | 4: 80% | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: 80% [4].
- **V1Q50. Which of the following produces the most greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source V1Q50). Choices: 1: China | 2: The European Union | 3: The United States | 4: India | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: China [1].

C.27 Michigan (2009)

- **Which party held the majority in the Michigan State Senate?** (open text; source q14). Scored correct: Republican Party [2]. Open party name at departure was lowercased and stripped of punctuation; explicit party spellings in metadata/knowledge_items.csv were accepted. The baseline source stores a coded party category, shown in correct_codes.
- **Which party held the majority in the Michigan State House of Representatives?** (open text; source q15). Scored correct: Democratic Party [1]. Open party name at departure was lowercased and stripped of punctuation; explicit party spellings in metadata/knowledge_items.csv were accepted. The baseline source stores a coded party category, shown in correct_codes.
- **Which state had an unemployment rate similar to Michigan?** (multiple choice; source q16). Choices: 1: Oregon | 2: West Virginia | 3: Ohio | 4: Louisiana. Scored correct: Oregon [1].
- **Under which condition could a person remain eligible for the Family Independence Program after 48 months?** (multiple choice; source q17). Choices: 1: Live in a county with high unemployment | 2: Fired from a job while on the Family Self-Sufficiency Plan | 3: Non-citizen on the Refugee Assistance Program | 4: Have a small child in the ChildFirst program. Scored correct: Live in a county with high unemployment [1].
- **About what percentage of African American children in Michigan lived in poverty?** (multiple choice; source q18). Choices: 1: Under 20% | 2: About 30% | 3: About 40% | 4: Over 50%. Scored correct: About 40% [3].
- **Where was the Democratic Party on the 1–7 scale from lower taxes and services to higher taxes and services?** (placement scale; source q4). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Republican Party on the 1–7 scale from lower taxes and services to higher taxes and services?** (placement scale; source q5). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 1, 2, 3 [1|2|3].

- **Where was the Democratic Party on the 1–7 scale from government action to reduce unemployment to letting the economy recover?** (placement scale; source q7). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 1, 2, 3 [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Republican Party on the 1–7 scale from government action to reduce unemployment to letting the economy recover?** (placement scale; source q8). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].

C.28 California What’s Next (2011)

- **Which party held the majority in the California State Senate?** (multiple choice; source q37). Choices: 1: Republican Party | 2: Democratic Party | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Democratic Party [2].
- **Which party held the majority in the California State Assembly?** (multiple choice; source q38). Choices: 1: Republican Party | 2: Democratic Party | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Democratic Party [2].
- **What legislative majority was needed to approve the proposed state budget?** (multiple choice; source q39). Choices: 1: Simple Majority of Both Houses | 2: Simple Majority Assembly & Two-Thirds Senate | 3: Two-Thirds of Both Houses | 4: Three-Fourths of Both Houses | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Two-Thirds of Both Houses [3].
- **What legislative majority was needed to raise taxes?** (multiple choice; source q40). Choices: 1: Simple Majority of Both Houses | 2: Simple Majority Assembly & Two-Thirds Senate | 3: Two-Thirds of Both Houses | 4: Three-Fourths of Both Houses | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Two-Thirds of Both Houses [3].
- **Who could sign a ballot measure?** (multiple choice; source q41). Choices: 1: Anyone 18+ | 2: Any Citizen 18+ | 3: Only Registered Voters | 4: Only Registered Voters Who Voted in Last Election | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Only Registered Voters [3].

C.29 America in One Room (2019)

- **Which political party holds the majority in the Senate?** (multiple choice; source PK1). Choices: 1: Democratic | 2: Republican | 3: Independent. Scored correct: Republican [2].
- **Which political party holds the majority in the House?** (multiple choice; source PK2). Choices: 1: Democratic | 2: Republican | 3: Independent. Scored correct: Democratic [1].
- **About how many undocumented immigrants are in the US?** (multiple choice; source PK3). Choices: 1: 10 million | 2: 20 million | 3: 30 million | 4: 40 million. Scored correct: 10 million [1].
- **Which of the following countries is NOT part of the Paris Agreement on the environment?** (multiple choice; source PK4). Choices: 1: Russia | 2: Turkey | 3: Iran | 4: All of the above. Scored correct: All of the above [4].
- **The Affordable Care Act allows which of the following?** (multiple choice; source PK5). Choices: 1: Stay on your parents’ healthcare plan until age 26 | 2: Eliminated annual and lifetime limits on insurance coverage | 3: Cannot charge women higher rates than men | 4: All of the above. Scored correct: All of the above [4].

- **What percentage is the highest tax rate for capital gains taxes?** (multiple choice; source PK6). Choices: 1: Under 10% | 2: Around 20% | 3: Around 30% | 4: More than 40%. Scored correct: Around 20% [2].
- **Which of the following organizations dealing with trade has the most countries?** (multiple choice; source PK7). Choices: 1: North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA) | 2: World Trade Organization (WTO) | 3: United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) | 4: Trans-Pacific Partnership (TPP). Scored correct: World Trade Organization (WTO) [2].

C.30 America in One Room: Climate (2021)

- **Which political party controls the majority in the Senate?** (multiple choice; source Q17). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **Which political party controls the majority in the House?** (multiple choice; source Q18). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **Which of the following best describes Net Zero?** (multiple choice; source Q19). Scored correct: Code 3 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **What is the name of a method by which government can encourage emitters to reduce greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source Q20). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **Which of the following emit greenhouse gas emissions?** (multiple choice; source Q21). Scored correct: Code 5 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **Which country emits the most greenhouse gas emissions?** (multiple choice; source Q22). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **The term fossil fuels refers to which of the following energy sources?** (multiple choice; source Q23). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.
- **Which international agreement is about climate change?** (multiple choice; source Q24). Scored correct: Code 1 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the keyed code is checked against reported item results.

C.31 Antimicrobial Resistance (2024)

- **What does antibiotic resistance mean?** (multiple choice; source knowledge_1). Scored correct: Code 4 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.
- **When was the latest discovery of a new antibiotic class that has reached the market?** (multiple choice; source knowledge_2). Scored correct: Code 4 (answer text not

recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.

- **Which of the following statements are true about antibiotics?** (multiple choice; source `knowledge_3`). Scored correct: Code 5 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.
- **Which of the following is a way to prevent infection in order to reduce antibiotic resistance?** (multiple choice; source `knowledge_4`). Scored correct: Code 5 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.
- **What does the term superbug mean?** (multiple choice; source `knowledge_5`). Scored correct: Code 4 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.
- **Which of the following statements is a fact about antibiotic resistance?** (multiple choice; source `knowledge_6`). Scored correct: Code 5 (answer text not recovered). Offered choice labels were not in the retained report; the key follows the study expert panel.